

BUA4003 PRINCIPLES OF ECONOMICS

SEMESTER 1 2026

Assessment 3 – Report

This assessment is worth 50% of total marks in the subject.

Due date: Friday 29 May 2026 11:59pm

Word count: 2500 words (+/-10%) excluding figures, tables, and references.

Intended Learning Outcomes:

1. Apply economic frameworks for policy and business decision-making.
2. Research and apply economic concepts to predict how changes in economic conditions may impact individuals, businesses and industries within market structures.
3. Critically analyse economic data to explain relationships between economic variables and their impacts on policy, business and individuals.
4. Construct and present logical and persuasive economic arguments and communicate concepts professionally.

Task description

You are an economic analyst working for the World Development Bank. You have been assigned the task of researching about a country and providing a detailed report on the economic performance and wellbeing of its citizens. This report will be used to brief senior management on the economic and social conditions in the selected country. The final report you produce should present the information in a concise, clear, and engaging manner, with a focus on the implications of the data for the country's citizens.

Details

Country selection and justification

- Choose one country in the world and provide an analytical justification for selecting this country. This could be based on factors such as:
 - Economic or social challenges the country faces.
 - Unique aspects of the country's development.
 - Relevance to global economic discussions.
- Explain why this country is of interest for an analysis of economic performance and wellbeing.

Research, data collection, and economic interpretation

- Collect and present time-series data (2004-2024) on the following categories. Note that data highlighted in red must be downloaded from the World Bank Country Data using [this link](#) unless it is unavailable.
 - Economic indicators: **GDP per capita, unemployment rate, inflation rate.**
 - Health indicators: **Life expectancy at birth, mortality rate - infant**, access to healthcare services.

- Education indicators: Average years of schooling, **literacy rates**.
 - Income distribution indicators: **Gini index, poverty rate**.
 - Other wellbeing indicators: Human Development Index (HDI), happiness index, **gender equality measures (e.g., gender wage gap, labour force participation rates)**.
- Discuss the country's economic and wellbeing condition using the collected data. While doing so, you should use data visualisation and present trends over time, not just single-year snapshots. You must interpret the indicators to explain what they reveal about the country's economic structure, living standards, inequality, health outcomes, and social wellbeing. Where possible, report changes over the past 20 years to highlight patterns, improvements, or setbacks in economic performance and citizen wellbeing.
 - Compare the country's performance to global averages or regional averages (e.g., OECD, ASEAN, African Union) wherever applicable. Highlight whether the country performs above or below these averages and critically interpret what these differences suggest about the country's development trajectory and challenges.
 - Support your economic interpretations with academic literature, government reports, or credible industry sources. All claims about causes, consequences, or implications must be justified with appropriate academic or policy evidence.

Policy implications and recommendations

- Identify the key takeaways from your research (highlight the most important patterns, challenges, or opportunities revealed through the economic and social indicators).
- Discuss what the statistics mean for government policy (explain how the data/statistics inform domestic government policy and the challenges the country's policymakers must address).
- Provide potential policy recommendations for improving wellbeing which are:
 - directly linked to the issues identified in the data analysis
 - feasible, given the country's economic and institutional context
 - supported, where possible, with references to academic studies, international reports (e.g., World Bank, UN), or successful policy examples from other countries.

Format and Submission Guidelines:

- You must use the **Assignment Template as your final document for submission** and submit it the Turnitin link (LMS) as a Microsoft Word document. Failure to do so will incur a 10% mark deduction.
- You must submit one Excel file containing all data downloaded. Data from each source should be included in one separate worksheet in one Excel file. Failure to do so will incur a 15% mark deduction.
- Tables/graphs/pictures need to be placed in the text and referred to as "Figure 1 – name of the figure", "Table 1 – name of the table".
- Provide sources for all data collected. Acceptable sources include the WB, UNDP, IMF, OECD, national government reports, and peer-reviewed academic articles. All data points must be accurately referenced using APA 7 style.
- Use the APA7 referencing style for both in-text and at the end of the document reference list. Refer to [Academic Referencing Tool](#) for more information.
- 12-point font text only (bold any headings or sub-heading).

Generative AI is allowed in this assessment at AI Planning level for planning, idea development and research. The final submission must show how you have developed and refined ideas and must be of your own words. Failure to do so might constitute academic misconduct.